Separately, in a note later submitted to the Parliamentary Finance panel (headed by Congress Member of Parliament Veerappa Moily), the RBI said that *on 7 November 2016*, the government of India sent them a letter stating 'to mitigate the triple problems of counterfeiting, terrorist financing and black money, the Central Board of the Reserve Bank may consider withdrawal of the legal tender status of the notes in high denominations of ₹500 and ₹1,000.' *Based on this letter, the Central Board of the RBI convened a meeting on 8 November 2016 at 5.30 p.m.*, for the withdrawal of the legal tender character of the ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes.[30]

As reported in the PAC submission, Governor Patel, two Deputy Governors, R. Gandhi and S.S. Mundra, and five independent directors of RBI, Nachiket Mor (National Director for the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation); Bharat N. Doshi (former Board Member and CFO of Mahindra and Mahindra); Sudhir Mankad (former Chief Secretary of Gujarat); Shaktikanta Das (the Secretary, Economic Affairs, MoF); and Anjuly Chib Duggal (the Secretary, Department of Financial Services, MoF) attended the board meeting. Of the other two Directors, Deputy Governor N.S. Vishwanathan did not attend the meeting as he stayed back in Mumbai for 'strategic reasons' (to brief the bankers first-hand, immediately after the decision on demonetization was taken). Another director, Natarajan Chandrasekaran (the then CEO and MD of TCS, and present Chairman of the Tata group of companies) was abroad.

In an article dated 21 January 2017,[31] *Reuters* stated that a copy of the private testimony to a Parliament panel, seen by them, showed the RBI had also warned the government of 'possible inconvenience to the public for some time' among the potential consequences of the massive exercise. Despite its own doubts, the testimony showed that the RBI board approved the plan to ban ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes, as it believed the move would rein in counterfeiting and reliance on cash, and pull unaccounted cash out of the financial system.